

## Intro

We want to develop an application that is a tool for conducting tastings and reviews of anything that has flavor or aroma. It needs to be both easy and fun to use for the average person, and a powerful tool for industry experts conducting tasting, blind tastings, competitions etc. This platform needs to be fully customizable so that it can be used across various industries. One key feature of this application is the flavor wheel data and visualization; User data will be used to create a number of different wheels that visualize the perception of flavor / aroma. It is our hope that this data will someday be a valuable part of this application.

## Landing Page / User Profile - Index

1. Username
2. Photo
3. Profile Data: Posts, Followers, Following
4. Bio
5. Create Post
6. Feed
7. Messages
8. Taste
9. Review
10. Flavor Wheels
11. Blind Tasting Score
12. Activity
13. Search

1. **Username:** A limited character format unique to, and set by each user.
2. **Photo:** A profile picture, uploaded by user.
3. **Profile Data:** **3.1 Posts:** Number of posts by user. **3.2 Followers:** Number of other users following user. **3.3 Following:** Number of other users user is Following.
4. **Bio:** A limited character biography created by each user.
5. **Create Post:** Upload picture / text / data from tasting or review.
6. **Feed:** A feed of pictures / data shared by users. Interactivity: like buttons, share buttons or similar.
7. **Messages:** Message board showing chat history with different users.

## 8. Taste:

**8.1. Quick Tasting:** A preset tasting format made for quick tasting on the fly:  
Item name, nose, mouth, other, overall score (1-100). Add item.

**8.2. Create Tasting:** 8.2.1 Create New | 8.2.2 Templates | 8.2.\*\* Blind / Not Blind | 8.2.\*\*\*  
Ranking

### 8.2.1 Create New:

In all tastings there exist **4 main variables**.

#### Participants

Example:                   1) Rion  
                              2) Ted  
                              3) Kristen

#### Items being tasted

Example:                   Item A) Cabernet 1  
                              Item B) Cabernet 2  
                              Item C) Cabernet 3

#### Characteristics of items

Example:                   1) Continent  
                              2) Intensity of Aroma  
                              3) Flavor

*\*We might want to add the ability to group characteristics (example: as the CMS Wine Grid groups various characteristics into Fruit, Non Fruit, Structure and Conclusion).*

**Assessment of characteristics** (Multiple Choice, Exact Answer, Contains, Range, Subjective)

Example:

Characteristic 1 'continent', MULTIPLE CHOICE: (Europe, North America, South America)  
Characteristic 2 'Intensity of Aroma', RANGE 1-5: (1 least intense, 5 most intense)  
Characteristic 3 'Flavor', SUBJECTIVE: (Participant adds descriptors)

The fully customizable nature of this application allows you to edit all of the data for these 4 main variables when setting up your tasting: You decide which participants, which items, by which characteristics those items will be judged, and by which methods those characteristics will be assessed.

*\*Assessment of characteristics might also include "instructions" (example: as the CMS Wine Grid gives instructions such as "non fruit descriptors combine NOSE and PALATE". "Select "YES" only if it is an important characteristic of the wine".*

## 8.2. \*\*Blind / Not Blind

Likewise, in all tastings, 3 of the 4 main variables can either be “blind” or “not blind”:

**Participants** ( You decide if they can see each other's names)

**Items** ( You decide if the participants will be able to see the names of the items or not, likewise you could decide that they will see some, but not others)

**Characteristics** ( You decide which, if any of the characteristics of the items will be visible to the participants) Example: You may decide to show them the wine they are tasting is from Europe, but make them fill in which country.

## 8.2. \*\*\*Ranking

There are two main reasons we conduct tastings: To measure something about the participants, or to measure something about the items (or both). With this application we use a special system that allows you to rank the participants (most accurate to least accurate), the items (favorite to least favorite) or both. Of course you may be conducting a non-blind tasting as a simple training exercise or as a way to collect subjective feedback from the judges on the items: this is why you will decide if ranking will be necessary in your tasting.

### 8.2.2 Templates: 8.2.2.1 Wine | 8.2.2.2 Beer | 8.2.2.3 Spirits | 8.2.2.4 Coffee | 8.2.2.5 Olive Oil | 8.2.2.6 Perfume

These will be preset templates commonly used by different industries such as the CMS Grid for wine or the SCA for coffee. These templates should conform to, and be completely reproducible by the rules we use in the Create Tasting section.

#### 8.2.2.1 Wine: 8.2.2.1.1 CMS WHITE WINE | 8.2.2.1.2 CMS RED WINE

#### 8.2.2.2 Beer: 8.2.2.2.1 BJCP

#### 8.2.2.3 Spirits:

#### 8.2.2.4 Coffee:

#### 8.2.2.5 Olive Oil

#### 8.2.2.6 Perfume

## 8.3 My Tastings: History of all tastings / downloadable .pdf

## 8.4 Join Tasting: Join tasting with a code shared by creator

9. **Review:** Similar to a quick tasting but with only the variables of *Item Being Tasted* (just one) and *Characteristics* (no Participants or Assessment of Characteristics necessary).

**9.1 Prose Review:** The user types a review in regular human prose / sentence / paragraph format and our algorithm / AI extracts aroma / flavor and non aroma / flavor descriptors into a database that can be used to visualize the data in a wheel format.

**9.2 Review:** Maybe a universal format for tasting / smelling or pre-made templates for various categories.

## 10. Flavor Wheels

4 Types: Aroma, Flavor, Combined, Metaphor

2 levels of Magnitude: Single User, Universal (all users)

### Flavor wheel generation / visualization

#### General idea:

A database is created with user data, item data, and input data: An AI scans input data and looks for words; flavor / aroma descriptors, it then groups this data into categories and sub categories and visualizes them in the format of a flavor wheel. This data could be visualized / produced for any level of magnitude: one item / review / a tasting / a user / all users.

Ideally, this data will be stored in such a way that it is easily parsable for future use. Example: Parse by; specific item (SKU # / Lot ID), Class: Mezcal, Category: Food, User Age Range 14-20, Tasting ID, User, Aroma, Taste, etc. etc.

#### Types of Flavor / Aroma / Other wheels:

##### Aroma

A circular chart with categories on the inside, then sub categories, then the aroma descriptors gleaned from the data, then aroma molecule information on the outermost ring.

Aroma molecule information is somewhat difficult because often numerous molecules or the combination of different molecules are responsible for one aroma / flavor; There are good databases that show this information [https://cosylab.iitd.edu.in/flavordb2/advance\\_search?](https://cosylab.iitd.edu.in/flavordb2/advance_search?) And maybe an AI could just offer 2 or 3 of the most common molecules or the 2 or 3 that are combined to make that note.

##### Flavor

A circular chart with categories on the inside, then sub categories, then the flavor descriptors gleaned from the data, then flavor molecule information on the outermost ring.

##### Combined Aroma / Flavor

The above two combined.

##### Metaphor Wheel

A metaphorical flavor/aroma type wheel that helps users describe complex sensory experiences—particularly when traditional tasting notes fall short. Instead of focusing solely on ingredients or direct smells, this wheel will organize abstract, emotional, and conceptual descriptors found in user data. Categories might include **Mood/Emotion** (e.g. brooding, joyful), **Setting/Place** (e.g. library, seaside), **Texture/Material** (e.g. powdery, metallic), **Color/Light** (e.g. golden, shadowy), **Movement/Shape** (e.g. spiraling, sharp), **Character/Persona** (e.g. flirtatious, aristocratic), and **Temporal/Time-based** (e.g. fleeting, nostalgic).

An AI model would assist in identifying and organizing these metaphorical descriptors from large datasets of tasting notes and reviews. It could dynamically sort words into categories—or propose new ones—based on emerging patterns. This tool will give users a more expressive and intuitive vocabulary for capturing sensory impressions beyond just flavor or aroma.

## Scope of Wheel

The wheel visualization could be used to analyze / zoom in on any subset of our data:

1. One specific item (SKU # xxxxxxxx)
2. One category of item (Madrecuixe, Mezcal, Spirits)
3. Gender of user (Man)
4. Place of user (Mexico)
5. Age range of user (20-25)
6. One specific user (self)
7. Universal (all users)

\*This ability might not be needed for the very first version, but we would at least want personal and universal (6 and 7).

### Personal Wheel

A wheel generated by one user's data. 4 different visualizations / parsings of the data (Flavor, Aroma, Combined, Metaphor).

### Universal Wheel

The same thing generated from ALL users' data.

**11. Blind Tasting Score:** A numerical score generated from the conglomerate rank in the users participation in all the blind tastings they have participated in.

**12. Activity:** Displays Number of Reviews, Number of Quick Tastings, Number of Tastings Created, Number of Tastings Participated in, Personal Flavor wheel

**13. Search:** Search for text / words / hashtags etc